Research Analysis on Skin Care

➢ What is Skin Care?

Skincare is the daily practice of maintaining, protecting, and improving skin health and appearance, bridging dermatology and cosmetics. A fundamental routine involves cleaning, moisturizing, and sun protection to prevent acne, aging, and damage. Key steps include using cleanser, moisturizer, and daily sunscreen (SPF 30+)

"The skin care choices you make now will affect what your skin looks like in your next decade – and beyond".

➢ Core Components of a Skincare Routine

1) Cleansing: Removes dirt, oil, and makeup to keep pores clear.

2) Moisturizing: Hydrates and locks in moisture to keep skin supple.

3) Sun Protection (Sunscreen): Crucial for preventing UV damage, premature aging, and skin cancer.

4) Treating/Active Products: Ingredients like retinol or Vitamin C target specific concerns such as acne, dark spots, or dryness.

➢ Types of Skin

Understanding types of skin is the foundation of effective skincare. Human skin varies from person to person based on genetics, environment, hormones, and lifestyle factors. These variations influence how much oil (sebum) the skin produces, how well it retains moisture, and how it reacts to external elements like weather, pollution, and skincare products.

In dermatology, skin is broadly classified into five main types based on oil production, hydration level, and sensitivity: -

1. **Normal Skin –** The skin is neither too dry nor too oily. It has regular texture, no imperfections and a clean, soft appearance, and does not need special care.

2. **Sensitive Skin-** Sensitive skin is more prone to react to stimuli to which normal skin has no reaction. It is a fragile skin, usually accompanied by feelings of discomfort, such as heat, tightness, redness or itching.

   Care Tips

   - Moisturizing twice daily helps strengthen the skin barrier and protect from irritation.

   -Ingredients like Dex panthenol (2.5–5%) reduce irritation

   -Sensitive-skin products are usually gentle, fragrance-free, and hypoallergenic.

3. **Oily Skin-**

   Oily skin is a skin type where the sebaceous glands produce excess oil (sebum).

   Skin looks shiny and greasy

   Prone to acne, pimples, and blackheads

   Has large, visible pores

   Less likely to wrinkle due to natural moisture.

   Care Tips

   - Cleanse face twice daily with a gentle face wash
   - Use oil-free, lightweight moisturizer
   - Apply sunscreen (SPF 30+) every day
   - Choose non-comedogenic products
   - Use ingredients like salicylic acid & niacinamide
   - Avoid over washing and heavy creams

4. **Dry Skin-**

   Dry skin is a skin type where the skin lacks moisture and natural oils.

   Feels tight, rough, or itchy

   May show flaking, redness, or cracks

   Looks dull and uneven

   More prone to early wrinkles.

   Lacks moisture → **flaky, tight, rough, sometimes cracked**

   Common on face, scalp, and exposed areas

Care tips:

- Use lukewarm water, avoid long baths
- Use gentle cleansers (pH 4–5)
- Moisturize at least twice daily
- Ingredients like **glycerin, urea, niacinamide** help retain moisture

5. **Combination Skin-**

Combination skin is a common skin type characterized by having both oily and dry areas on the face simultaneously. Typically, this involves an oily "T-zone"—the forehead, nose, and chin—while the cheeks and outer areas of the face remain dry, normal, or flaky.

Care Tips

Use a gentle cleanser
Apply lightweight moisturizer (not too heavy)
Use different products for different areas if needed
Apply sunscreen daily.

➢ TYPES OF SKINCARE ROUTINES:

Morning = Protection

Night = Repair

A. MORNING ROUTINE (AM Routine)

Essential Morning Routine - The morning skincare routine focuses on cleansing, protection, and hydration to prepare the skin for environmental exposure such as sunlight, pollution, and dirt. A well-structured morning routine helps maintain skin health and prevents long-term damage.

1. **Cleanse:** Use a gentle, sulphate-free cleanser to remove oil without drying.
2. **Toner (Optional):** Apply a hydrating or balancing toner to prep skin. (Hydrates + balances pH)

3. **Serum (Essential):** Use an antioxidant serum (like Vitamin C for brightness and Niacinamide for oil control)
4. **Eye Cream (Optional)**: Helps reduce puffiness and under-eye bags. Gives a fresh, hydrated look.
5. **Moisturize (Essential) :** Apply a lightweight moisturizer suited to your skin type. To maintain skin barrier.
6. **Sunscreen (Essential):** Apply SPF 30 or higher, even on cloudy days. (Prevents aging + skin cancer)
7. **Lip balm with SPF (Optional)**: Lips have no melanin protection. An SPF lip balm prevents dryness, sun damage, and premature lines around the mouth.
   SPF 15+ minimum. Reapply after eating.

CLEANSE -> PREP-> TREAT-> MOISTURIZE-> PROTECT

B. NIGHT ROUTINE (PM Routine)

Essential Night Routine- The evening skincare routine is designed to remove impurities accumulated throughout the day and support skin repair during the night. Since the skin undergoes natural regeneration while sleeping, this routine focuses on cleansing, treatment, and hydration.

1. **Double Cleanse**: Use an oil-based cleanser followed by a water-based cleanser to remove makeup and sunscreen.
   [**Oil / Micellar Cleanser (Essential)**
   Removes sunscreen, makeup, oil, and pollution. Massage ~60 sec.
   Water-Based Cleanser (Essential)
   Cleans leftover dirt and keeps skin barrier healthy.]
2. **Toner (Optional)**: Reapply toner to balance the skin. Hydrates and prepares skin for better absorption.
3. **Treat**: Apply targeted treatments (e.g., serums for acne or aging).
   - Retinol / Retinoid (Essential)
     Anti-aging improves skin texture. Use 2–3x/week initially.

- Niacinamide (Essential)
  Reduces oil, evens tone, strengthens skin barrier.
- Hyaluronic Acid (Essential)
  Deep hydration; apply on slightly damp skin.
- Spot Treatment (Optional)
  For acne or pigmentation (apply only on affected areas).
- Peptides (Optional)
  Boost collagen and skin repair.

4. **Moisturize**: Use a richer cream to hydrate overnight.
   - **Eye Cream (Optional)**
     Hydrates and reduces fine lines.
   - **Night Moisturizer (Essential)**
     Locks moisture and repairs skin barrier.
   - **Face Oil (Optional)**
     Seals hydration and prevents water loss.
   - **Sleeping Mask (Optional)**
     Deep repair and hydration (2–3x/week).

CLEANSE -> PREP-> TREAT-> MOISTURIZE

Tips for Specific Needs:

- **Oily/Combination Skin:** Use gel-based, non-comedogenic, and oil-free products.
- **Dry/Sensitive Skin:** Look for creamy, hydrating, and alcohol-free products.
- **Weekly Exfoliation:** Use chemical exfoliants (AHAs/BHAs) 1-2 times a week to remove dead skin cells, rather than harsh scrubs.
- **Consistency & Patience:** It takes time to see results from new products

Here's a summary of the key principles behind this breakdown:

- **Why some steps are AM-only:** Vitamin C is unstable in UV light, so it works best in the morning where it partners with sunscreen to fight free radicals. SPF is obviously a daytime-only step and is the single most impactful thing you can do for your skin long-term.
- **Why some steps are PM-only:** Retinol degrades when exposed to sunlight and also makes skin more sun-sensitive, so it must be used at night. Oil cleansers

and exfoliants belong in the evening because your skin has a full day of build-up to break down, and nighttime is when skin naturally enters its repair cycle.

- **Why actives like niacinamide and HA work AM + PM:** These are stable, non-photosensitizing ingredients that support the skin barrier at any time of day. Using them twice daily consistently produces the fastest visible results.
- **The essential core (minimum effective routine):** If you strip everything down, the non-negotiable steps are — morning: water cleanser → niacinamide or HA → moisturizer → SPF. Evening: double cleanse → retinol (2–3x/week) or niacinamide → moisturizer. Everything else is a targeted upgrade based on your specific skin concerns.

➢ Here's what makes each skin type's routine fundamentally different from the others:

- **Oily skin's** biggest mistake is over-cleansing or skipping moisturizer — both worsen oil production by signalling the skin to produce more sebum to compensate. The goal is to regulate, not strip. Niacinamide and BHA are the two most powerful allies here.

- **Dry skin** needs to think in layers — each step locks in the one before it, building a moisture sandwich. The essence → serum → moisturizer → oil sequence creates progressively more occlusive layers that prevent trans epidermal water loss overnight.
- **Combination skin** is best managed by thinking of your face as two separate zones. Don't compromise — use different products or apply differently on the T-zone vs cheeks. Niacinamide is uniquely effective here because it balances both zones at once.
- **Sensitive skin** should follow a "less is more" philosophy. The fewer ingredients, the less chance of a reaction. When introducing anything new, one product at a time with a full two-week trial period is the safest approach. Bakuchiol is a genuinely effective and far gentler alternative to retinol for this skin type.
- **Normal skin** has the most flexibility, so the focus should shift entirely to prevention — using actives proactively before concerns appear rather than reactively after. Consistent SPF + Vitamin C in the morning and retinol at night is the most evidence-backed long-term strategy for maintaining healthy skin.

Oily	Dry	Combination	Sensitive	Normal
Excess sebum Enlarged pores Shiny texture	Low moisture Flakiness Tight feeling	Oily T-zone Dry cheeks Mixed texture	Prone to redness Reacts easily Thin barrier	Balanced skin Few concerns Even texture
Niacinamide Salicylic acid Lightweight gel	Ceramides Hyaluronic acid Rich creams	Niacinamide Balancing serums Zone-targeted	Centella asiatica Fragrance-free Minimal actives	Antioxidants SPF daily Maintenance

Top row: characteristics · Bottom row: recommended approach · Click any type to learn more

➢ Here's a breakdown of the most important ingredient categories:

HYDRATION	BARRIER REPAIR	ANTI-AGING	BRIGHTENING	PROTECTION	EXFOLIATION
Hyaluronic Acid	**Ceramides**	**Retinoids**	**Niacinamide (B3)**	**Mineral SPF**	**Lactic Acid (AHA)**
Holds up to 1000x its weight in water. Multi-weight formulas now penetrate deeper layers.	Lipids that form the skin's protective barrier. Essential for dry, sensitive, and compromised skin.	Top-ranked in 2025 research. Boosts collagen, speeds cell turnover, reduces fine lines and dark spots.	Reduces pores, evens tone, controls oil, and pairs well with ceramides or tranexamic acid.	#1 ranked ingredient for skin health. Zinc oxide & titanium dioxide block UVA/UVB and prevent aging.	Gentle exfoliant that also hydrates. Start at 5–10% a few times weekly. Pairs well with ceramides.
All skin types	Dry · Sensitive	PM use only	All skin types	Daily essential	Normal · Dry

➢ Korean "Glass Skin" Routine: Deep Analysis

Concept:
"Glass skin" refers to a complexion that is exceptionally clear, luminous, and seemingly translucent, resembling glass. The look emphasizes a smooth, even-toned, intensely hydrated, and glowing skin surface.

Core Principles:

- **Hydration and Moisture:** The foundation of glass skin is deeply moisturized skin, achieved through layering lightweight hydrating products like essences, toners, and serums.
- **Exfoliation**: Regular but gentle exfoliation is crucial to remove dead skin cells and promote a smooth texture without irritation.
- **Brightening:** Ingredients that even out skin tone and reduce hyperpigmentation such as niacinamide, vitamin C, and licorice root extract are used.
- **Sun Protection**: Daily use of sunscreen is essential to prevent damage and maintain skin clarity.
- **Layering:** The routine involves multiple steps, layering products from light to heavier textures to build hydration and nourishment without clogging pores.

Typical Steps:

1. **Double Cleansing:** Oil-based cleanser followed by a water-based cleanser to thoroughly remove impurities.
2. **Exfoliation:** Chemical exfoliants (AHAs, BHAs) or gentle physical exfoliants, used 1-2 times per week.
3. **Toner:** Hydrating toners to prep the skin and restore pH balance.
4. **Essence:** Lightweight, highly hydrating treatment to boost moisture and skin repair.
5. **Serum/Ampoule:** Targeted treatments for brightening, anti-aging, or calming.
6. **Moisturizer:** Lightweight or gel-based for hydration without heaviness.
7. **Sunscreen:** Broad-spectrum SPF to protect skin from UV damage.

Key Ingredients:

- Hyaluronic acid (for moisture retention)

- Snail mucin (for repair and hydration)
- Centella asiatica (calming and healing)
- Niacinamide (brightening and barrier support)
- Peptides (for anti-aging)

➢ Modern Skincare Trends:

- **Skinimalism:**
  A simplified skincare approach focusing on fewer, multi-functional products that deliver effective results without a complicated routine, promoting natural, healthy skin.

- **Microbiome Skincare:**
  Products designed to support and balance the skin's natural microbial community, helping to strengthen the skin barrier and reduce sensitivity or inflammation.

- **Sustainable and Clean Beauty:**
  Skincare that prioritizes eco-friendly packaging, cruelty-free testing, and formulas free from harmful or controversial ingredients to promote health and environmental responsibility.

- **Personalized Skincare:**
  Tailored skincare routines and products based on individual skin types, concerns, genetics, and lifestyle factors, often using technology and diagnostics for precision.

- **Blue Light Protection:**
  Formulations that protect the skin from damage caused by blue light emitted from digital devices, aiming to prevent premature aging and pigmentation.

- **Barrier Repair Focus:**
  Emphasis on strengthening the skin's protective barrier using ingredients like ceramides and fatty acids to maintain hydration, reduce irritation, and improve overall skin health.

- **Holistic Approaches:**
  A comprehensive view of skincare that includes lifestyle factors such as diet,

sleep, stress management, and mental wellness to enhance skin health from the inside out.

➢ Common Skincare Mistakes:

1. **Over-Exfoliating:**
   Using physical or chemical exfoliants too frequently can damage the skin barrier, causing irritation, redness, and sensitivity.
2. **Skipping Sunscreen:**
   Neglecting daily sun protection leads to premature aging, pigmentation, and increased risk of skin cancer.
3. **Using Harsh Products:**
   Products with strong fragrances, alcohol, or irritants can disrupt the skin barrier and cause dryness or breakouts.
4. **Not Removing Makeup Properly:**
   Inadequate cleansing leaves residue that clogs pores and leads to acne or dull skin.
5. **Applying Products in the Wrong Order:**
   Incorrect layering can reduce product effectiveness (e.g., applying heavy creams before lightweight serums).
6. **Touching Face Frequently:**
   Hands transfer dirt and bacteria, increasing the risk of breakouts and infections.
7. **Ignoring Hydration:**
   Focusing only on cleansing or treatment while neglecting moisturization can lead to dry, flaky skin.
8. **Changing Products Too Often:**
   Switching products too quickly prevents the skin from adjusting and makes it hard to identify what works.

➢ Tips for Better Skincare:

- Exfoliate gently and limit to 1-2 times per week.
- Always apply broad-spectrum sunscreen every morning.
- Choose products suited for your skin type and avoid harsh ingredients.
- Double cleanse to ensure all makeup and impurities are removed.
- Apply skincare from thinnest to thickest texture for optimal absorption.
- Keep hands clean and avoid touching your face unnecessarily.

- Include a good moisturizer to maintain skin hydration and barrier function.
- Give new products at least 4-6 weeks before judging their effectiveness.

Summary

Good skincare is about consistency, using the right products, and protecting your skin from damage. Avoiding common mistakes like over-exfoliation, skipping sunscreen, and improper cleansing helps maintain healthy, glowing skin. Adopting gentle, well-ordered routines and being patient with products can lead to the best results. Remember, prevention and care go hand-in-hand for lasting skin health.